



Training methods of champions



Besides tennis champions Novak Djokovic, Serena Williams, and Maria Sharapova (left), several other sports superstars have used hyperbaric oxygen therapy (HBOT).

They include Cristiano Ronaldo, LeBron James, Michael Jordan, Simone Biles, Lindsey Vonn, Michael Phelps, and Usain Bolt. Proven benefits for athletic performance include accelerated recovery, reduced inflammation, improved oxygen intake, increased endurance, enhanced mental focus, improved speed and power, and treatment of sports injuries.

Salt room therapy is another increasingly popular training method used by Novak Djokovic.

According to *saltchamberinc.com*, "Halotherapy (aka salt therapy) is a holistic therapy that involves breathing in salty air. Halotherapy is a fast-growing treatment that may provide numerous health benefits for people with respiratory and skin conditions, as well as anxiety and depression. The effectiveness of salt therapy is dependent on a halogenerator. This machine grinds particles of pure-grade sodium chloride (salt). Then, it disperses the particles into a hygienic and controlled environment known as a salt room."

Less known in the sports world but highly effective is a machine designed for astronauts to help prevent their muscles from atrophying in zero gravity.

The use of this machine strengthened the left arm of the teenage Rafael Nadal. And that well-muscled physiological weapon — combined with his great athleticism and Western grip — created Nadal's out-of-this-world topspin forehand, averaging 3,200 revolutions per minute and peaking at over 5,000 rpm. The greatest groundstroke in tennis history bounded viciously over and outside opponents' strike zones and helped Rafa capture 22 Grand Slam titles.

Was it just a coincidence when the six-year world record for the indoor mile fell twice within five days?

U. S. runner Yared Nuguse set it on February 9, only for Norway's Jakob Ingebrigtsen to eclipse it on February 14. Super spike shoes and high-tech track surfaces designed to propel runners faster than ever before partly account for this rapid record-smashing. However, a perfectly legal supplement that middle-distance runners call "Bicarb" could also explain it. Its main ingredient is sodium bicarbonate — household baking soda — which helps reduce the painful physiological effects of shorter, maximum-intensity exercise.